

Weekly Writing - Week 1

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09 September, 2025

Getting Started on the content

The first week was really about getting set up and understanding what this class is all about. On the technical side, I got R, RStudio, and tinytex running and learned how to use RMarkdown. It's nice that everything, code and writing, goes in one place, and knitting makes sure the work is reproducible. I also realized I shouldn't just type things into the console, because that doesn't save my steps.

Content-wise, the main point was that data analytics is about finding value in data, but we have to be careful about correlation vs. causation. The prison example made it clear that just because two things move together doesn't mean one causes the other. I like that this course will focus on prediction first but still keep the "why" in mind.

Overall, it felt like a good reset, get the tools in order, start with the basics, and remember to stay thoughtful about what the data is really saying.